Results at a glance

The program started in a single neighbourhood and now runs in five. Each site has a coordinator, a group of volunteers and a small budget for materials.

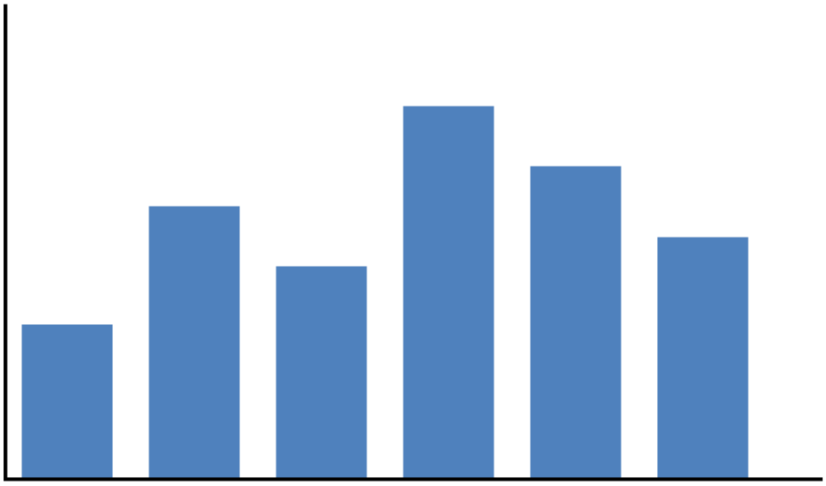

Figure 1. Sessions held per month, January to June.

Families told us that the most useful part was the evening sessions, because parents could join after work. We moved two thirds of the sessions to the evening in spring.

Attendance grew steadily through the year. The largest increase came after the local library agreed to host the sessions and to promote them in its newsletter.

We tracked three outcomes: reading level, attendance and parent participation. All three improved, although the change in reading level was smaller than planned.